Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of the seven colours yellow is between orange and green. In the current rainbow map of the chakras it belongs **to the third chakra** and the themes of self-worth, **will and decision-making**.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root

Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. Do I have something to lean on? What gives me a sense of safety right now?



Orange · sacral

Experiencing, pleasure, creating. Ask yourself. What does me good? Where do I allow myself joy?



Yellow · solar plexus

Self-worth, will. Ask yourself. What do I want? Where do I need to stand up for myself?



Green · heart

Closeness, relationships. Ask yourself. How am I with myself? Whom do I let close?



Blue · throat

Voice, expression. Ask yourself. What do I need to say? What do I no longer want to swallow?



Indigo · third eye

Inner vision, intuition. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown

Meaning, transcendence, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me meaning? What do I feel connected to?

Orange may ask “what delights me?”, yellow “**will I allow myself** to want it?” and green “how do I **stay kind to myself and others** while doing so?”

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Manipura, the solar plexus chakra

Chakras come from the **Indian yoga and tantric tradition**. **The third chakra is called Manipura** (in Sanskrit “city of jewels”). It dwells in the area of the navel and solar plexus. The **element of fire**, the sound **syllable RAM** and a lotus with ten petals belong to it, which the classical descriptions give as dark blue or black, “like heavy rain clouds”. Yellow is linked with it mainly in today's view, although a yellow circle also appears in the traditional depiction (the red triangle of fire in a yellow circle). Sources differ in details.

Its theme is **fire, transformation, personal power and will**. For women this is often translated into questions. **Do I have the right** to my own opinion and to stand behind it? **Can I ask** for my place? **Do I know what I want**?

This does not mean you have to be the loudest in the room. Sometimes the greater expression of your own strength is quiet.

When it is open. You know what you want and can say it. You trust your abilities and do not have to keep comparing yourself. Your **energy flows** and you make decisions without long hesitation.

When it is closed. The tradition describes insecurity, a need for approval from others, a fear of mistakes or, on the contrary, a need to control. Closed does not mean bad. It is only a signal that perhaps you do not yet allow yourself to take your place.

How to add yellow when you are missing confidence

- **Wear it**
  A yellow scarf, jumper or earrings. Something that makes you stand out but does not shout.
- **Put it in your home**
  A yellow cushion, flower or mug. Fresh lemons on the table.
- **Eat it**
  Lemons, sweetcorn, bananas, pumpkin, turmeric. With relish and in peace.
- **Treat yourself to some sun**
  Five minutes in the sun, a window that lets in the morning light.
- **Paint it**
  A large yellow area in the middle of the paper. A sun that is allowed to be big.
- **Fit it into the morning**
  A yellow mug at breakfast, a napkin or a spoon. A small flash of light at the start of the day.

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How to top up or take away yellow when you are already the hamster in the cage?

When your head is running at full revs, **you do not need more yellow, but something that slows you down**.

- **Mute the yellow**
  Replace a rich one with butter, sand or ochre. Add green or blue. Calm and a breath. A plant, water, a blue blanket.

- **Add brown**
  Support and stability. Wood, natural materials, the ground under your feet.

When your own will gets lost

Modern interpretations describe a weakened or “closed” manipura as an image of self-distrust, indecision and leaving your own direction to others. If you want to work with this image, **you can try** a short exercise with colour.

When the inner fire burns you more than it warms

The image of an overactive manipura is used for excessive control, competitiveness or a need to keep proving your worth.

Perhaps you rest, but you check whether you are resting efficiently enough. You finish one thing and instead of **satisfaction** you are already looking for the next. When someone does things differently, you feel like taking it out of their hands at once.

Here the advice “add even more radiant yellow” could miss what you need.

Instead of further encouragement, try softening the whole experience. Swap lemon for butter, a large area for a small detail, a sharp contrast for a calmer companion.

If green, cream or a muted blue is pleasant to you, hold it next to the yellow and compare the feeling. Sometimes you need less intensity, not a different symbol.

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A short moment with the colour yellow

Sit down **comfortably** and put a yellow fabric or paper in front of you. Let your breath be natural.

Notice the colour for a while. Then **you can** close your eyes and imagine a small soft sun in the area of your belly. It does not have to light up the whole city. It is enough if it is pleasant for you.

If you are rather losing yourself at the moment, **you can** let it take up a little more space in your imagination. If you are pushing yourself, let its light soften.

If you want to add sound, **you can** quietly say **RAM** on a **comfortable** exhale. The voice does not have to be strong, the exhale long or the feeling extraordinary. The sound can give attention a simple point to return to.

At the end open your eyes and look around. **Notice** whether you feel the same, more pleasant, or whether this form of work does not suit you.

Can I connect yellow with another chakra?

In symbolic work **you can** connect the themes of individual colours.

- **Yellow and red**
  Your own decision together with support. Good for reflection when you know what you want but are afraid of losing security.
- **Yellow and orange**
  Decision-making together with pleasure. When you can fulfil tasks but have forgotten that you may also want something for joy.
- **Yellow and green**
  Self-worth together with closeness. When you feel that standing up for yourself means hurting someone.
- **Yellow and blue**
  Decision together with expression. When you are already clear but the words still stay inside.
- **Yellow and indigo**
  Will together with inner vision. When you know what is proper but something quietly leads elsewhere.
- **Yellow and violet**
  Action together with meaning. When you do a lot and begin to lose the answer to the question why.

This is work with meaning and your own experience. It has not been shown that by adding a specific colour you measurably regulate a chakra.

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And ask yourself

Do I know what I want, or mainly what is expected of me?

Do I need more **courage** to decide today, or less pressure on myself?

When do I allow myself to be content with myself without having finished something else first?

Picture it with an example

Next to yellow other colours can feel brighter. Blue calms it, green softens it and violet highlights it. **These are possibilities of personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a colour combination.

How to use this map

You **do not have to** go through all the colours or find one right one. Stop at the theme that touches you right now.

Perhaps yellow attracts you, but while reading you find that you do know how to decide. What you lack is rather the **courage** to voice your decision. Then blue may interest you too.

Or you have plans enough but nowhere to draw strength from. At such a moment the theme of support may be more important than another prompt to perform.

The map is meant to help you tell apart your own needs. It is not meant to turn your choice of colour into a verdict.

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